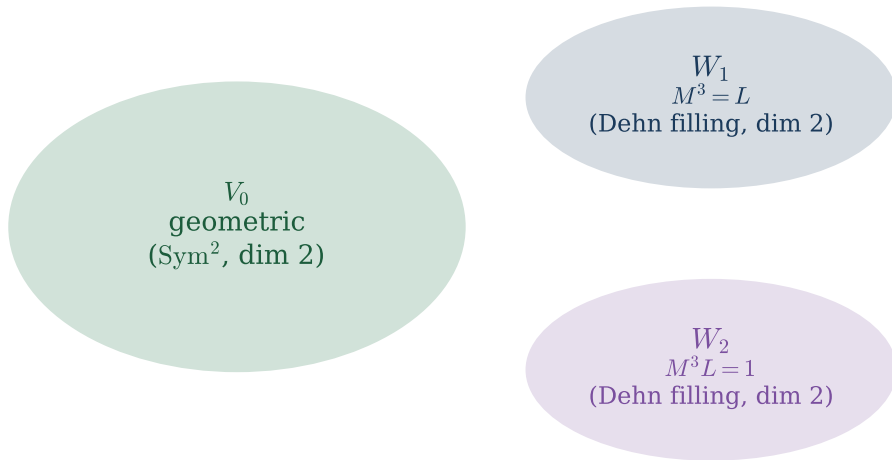


SL(3) figure-eight character variety: the degree = rank base case

KNOWN



Three components reproduced exactly by the trace map (matches Falbel/HMP); the boundary A -variety is $M^3 = L$ and $M^3 L = 1$.